Universal Human Values – II (UHV-II)

Module 1 · Session 4 — Student Activity Worksheet

Lecture 4 — Continuous Happiness and Prosperity (the Basic Human Aspirations)

Session	4	**Lecture**	Lecture 4
Topic	Continuous Happiness and Prosperity — the Basic Human Aspirations (happiness = harmony; prosperity = a feeling)		
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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, the student should be able to:

- Define happiness and unhappiness in terms of harmony and disharmony.
- Explain continuity of happiness as harmony at all four levels of being.
- Explain prosperity as a feeling and distinguish a prosperous person from a deprived one.

How to Engage with this Session (The Process)

- Whatever is said is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance.
- It is a dialogue: first with the teacher, then within your own self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- Happiness = to be in a state of harmony (naturally acceptable); unhappiness = to be forced into disharmony/contradiction.
- Continuity of happiness = harmony at all four levels: human being, family, society, nature/existence.
- Prosperity = the feeling of having/producing more than the required physical facility.
- A prosperous person thinks of right utilisation and nurturing the other; a deprived person of accumulation and exploiting the other.
- Physical facility: identification, production, consuming (right utilisation), sharing, storage — what is naturally acceptable is right utilisation.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Harmony = Happiness, Disharmony = Unhappiness

Classify each state as Happiness (harmony) or Unhappiness (disharmony).

State / situation	Happiness or Unhappiness?
Clarity / solution within	Happiness (Harmony)
Confusion / problem within	Unhappiness (Disharmony)
In harmony with family members	Happiness (Harmony)
In conflict / opposition with others	Unhappiness (Disharmony)

Activity 2 — Continuity = Harmony at Four Levels

Write the four levels of being at which harmony must be ensured for continuity of happiness.

The four levels at which harmony must be ensured are:

1. Individual (Self / "I")
2. Family
3. Society
4. Nature / Existence

Activity 3 — Prosperous or Deprived?

Complete the contrast and then reflect.

A prosperous person thinks of…	A deprived person thinks of…
Right utilization of physical facilities and nurturing others.	Endless accumulation and exploiting others.
Sharing surplus resources with society.	Hoarding out of continuous fear of scarcity

How much physical facility is "required" for you? On what basis would you decide?

Physical facility required is evaluated based on the body's actual needs for protection, nourishment, and right utilization. Decisions are made by identifying physical targets rather than comparing wealth with others.

Activity 4 — Handling Physical Facility

Number the steps in order and mark what is naturally acceptable (right utilisation / indulgence / renunciation): identification, production, consuming, sharing, storage.

Ordered Sequence:

1. Identification of physical needs
2. Production of physical facilities
3. Storage for future availability
4. Sharing with others
5. Consuming (Right utilization)

- **Naturally Acceptable Approach:** Right Utilization.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Define happiness and unhappiness as presented, and explain what is meant by “continuity of happiness.”

Happiness: A state of inner harmony. To be in a situation or mindset that is naturally acceptable is happiness.

Unhappiness: A state of inner disharmony or contradiction. To be forced into states that violate natural acceptance leads to unhappiness.

Continuity of Happiness: Sustained harmony across all four levels of existence—Self, Family, Society, and Nature/Existence—without interruption.

Q2. What is prosperity? Distinguish between a prosperous person and a deprived person.

Prosperity: The feeling of having or producing more physical facilities than are required for the body.

Distinction:

Prosperous Person: Accurately identifies physical needs, produces or acquires more than required, and possesses a mindset focused on right utilization, sharing, and nurturing others.

Deprived Person: Focuses on accumulation regardless of existing wealth, views resources as insufficient, and operates from fear, exploitation, and hoarding.

Q3. Explain why clarity about the basic human aspiration is important, and what our program is for fulfilling it.

Importance of Clarity: Without clarity on basic human aspirations (continuous happiness and prosperity), human effort becomes misdirected toward accumulating material wealth, causing internal conflict and environmental destruction.

Program for Fulfilment:

1. Developing **Right Understanding** in the Self through self-exploration.
2. Establishing **Right Feelings** in relationships to achieve mutual happiness.
3. Ensuring **Right Utilization** of physical facilities to achieve mutual prosperity with nature.